Republic of the Philippines
Bicol University
College of Education
Experiential Learning Office
Daraga, Albay, Philippines

Field Study 1 portfolio · Print edition

Observations of Teaching-Learning in Actual School Environment

The Observer's Edition

Pre-service teacher observer

Francois Joshua L. Bajandi

Bachelor of Secondary Education (Major in English)

Fourth Year (BSEd English IV)

Resource teacher

Herson N. Alamo

Teacher VI · Secondary English & Campus Journalism Mentor

English (Journalism, Composition, and Literature)

Table of contents

Act I: Opening

Acknowledgement

Act II: Foundations

Field Study 1 course description and learning outcomes

Prayer of the field study student

Personal educational philosophy

Bicol University and DepEd vision and mission

Act III: The field (Episodes 01–06)

Episode 02: The Learning Environment

Episode 03: Learner Behavior and Motivation

Act IV: Evidence and appendices

Resource teacher profile, class program, worksheets, and clearance

Acknowledgement

The completion of this Field Study 1 Portfolio—The Observer's Edition—stands as a testament to the generosity, mentorship, and intellectual rigor of the educators and peers who guided my transition from university theory to the living reality of the public school classroom.

Foremost, I extend my deepest gratitude to my Cooperating Resource Teacher, Mr. Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI. His mastery of secondary English instruction, journalistic precision, and calm, structured classroom authority offered a daily masterclass in what it means to teach with both high standards and genuine empathy. Thank you for opening your classroom, your lesson plans, and your reflective practice to my constant inquiry.

To the faculty and administrators of the Bicol University College of Education and the Experiential Learning Office in Daraga, Albay: thank you for designing a field immersion framework that challenges pre-service teachers not merely to watch, but to read the classroom critically through the lens of the Philippine Professional Standards for Teachers.

To my fellow editors and writers at UNDERCURRENTS, whose commitment to truthful observation and editorial craft sharpened the documentary eye I brought into every classroom session; and to my family, whose quiet sacrifices and unwavering encouragement sustain my vocation as an educator—this work is gratefully dedicated to you.

Act II: Foundations

Field Study 1 is the first experiential learning course in the Bachelor of Secondary Education program, anchored on the Philippine Professional Standards for Teachers (PPST) and CHED Memorandum Order No. 75, s. 2017. It immerses the pre-service teacher in an authentic public secondary school environment to observe, document, and analyze how learners develop, how learning environments are structured, and how veteran educators orchestrate curriculum, pedagogy, and assessment.

Course learning outcomes

Outcome 1: Analyze how the Resource Teacher translates curriculum competencies into developmentally sequenced, research-based instructional strategies and ICT-supported learning experiences in secondary English. (PPST Domain 1: Content Knowledge and Pedagogy)

Outcome 2: Evaluate the physical, psychological, and socio-emotional dimensions of the school campus and classroom in promoting learner safety, inclusivity, and purposeful engagement. (PPST Domain 2: Learning Environment)

Outcome 3: Observe and document differentiated teaching practices that respond to learners' linguistic, cultural, socio-economic, and developmental profiles. (PPST Domain 3: Diversity of Learners)

Outcome 4: Examine how daily lesson logs, learning resources, and collaborative departmental planning align instructional activities with national K to 12 curriculum standards. (PPST Domain 4: Curriculum and Planning)

Outcome 5: Critique the design and implementation of diagnostic, formative, and summative assessment tools, rubric systems, and constructive feedback loops. (PPST Domain 5: Assessment and Reporting)

Outcome 6: Identify how school-community partnerships, parental communication, and organizational norms strengthen the broader educational ecosystem. (PPST Domain 6: Community Linkages and Professional Engagement)

Outcome 7: Articulate an evolving philosophy of teaching grounded in ethical practice, reflective inquiry, and lifelong professional learning. (PPST Domain 7:

Personal Growth and Professional Development)

Prayer of the Field Study Student

Lord of Wisdom and Light, as I step across the threshold of the classroom, quiet my assumptions and sharpen my attention.

Grant me the humility of a true observer—to see every learner not as a seat on a chart, but as a story in progress; to recognize the unseen labor behind every lesson; and to honor the trust placed in those who teach.

May the words I record in these pages be honest, may the questions I ask be rooted in care, and may the educator I am becoming always serve truth, clarity, and the dignity of every student. Amen.

Personal Educational Philosophy

“ I believe that every language classroom is a workshop of human agency—where disciplined craft meets democratic voice, and where no learner is left silent on the margins. ”

Francois Joshua L. Bajandi · Field Study 1 · Academic Year 2025–2026

I believe that language instruction is fundamentally **an act of empowerment and civic enfranchisement**, transforming the English classroom from a site of passive rule-memorization into a living forum where students learn to interrogate texts, weigh evidence, and articulate truth with clarity.

I hold that pedagogical authority and **psychological safety are mutually reinforcing**: learners take intellectual risks in speaking, writing, and literary interpretation only when classroom routines are transparent, equitable, and anchored in genuine respect.

I view the teacher as both **architect of scaffolding and attentive editor of growth**—someone who models excellence explicitly, listens closely to student thinking before intervening, and uses assessment not to sort learners, but to illuminate their next step forward.

Bicol University

Vision: A world-class university producing leaders and change agents for social transformation and development.

Mission: The Bicol University shall primarily give professional and technical training, and provide advanced and specialized instruction in literature, philosophy, the sciences and arts, besides providing for the promotion of scientific and technological researches (RA 5521, Sec. 3.0).

Department of Education

Vision: We dream of Filipinos who passionately love their country and whose values and competencies enable them to realize their full potential and contribute meaningfully to building the nation. As a learner-centered public institution, the Department of Education continuously improves itself to better serve its stakeholders.

Mission: To protect and promote the right of every Filipino to quality, equitable, culture-based, and complete basic education where: Students learn in a child-friendly, gender-sensitive, safe, and motivating environment; Teachers facilitate learning and constantly nurture every learner; Administrators and staff, as stewards of the institution, ensure an enabling and supportive environment for effective learning to happen; Family, community, and other stakeholders are actively engaged and share responsibility for developing life-long learners.

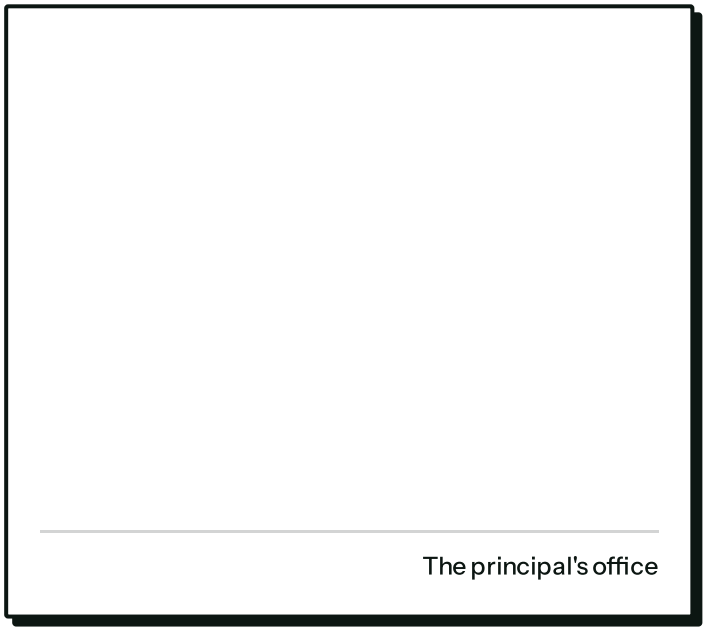
02 · The Learning Environment

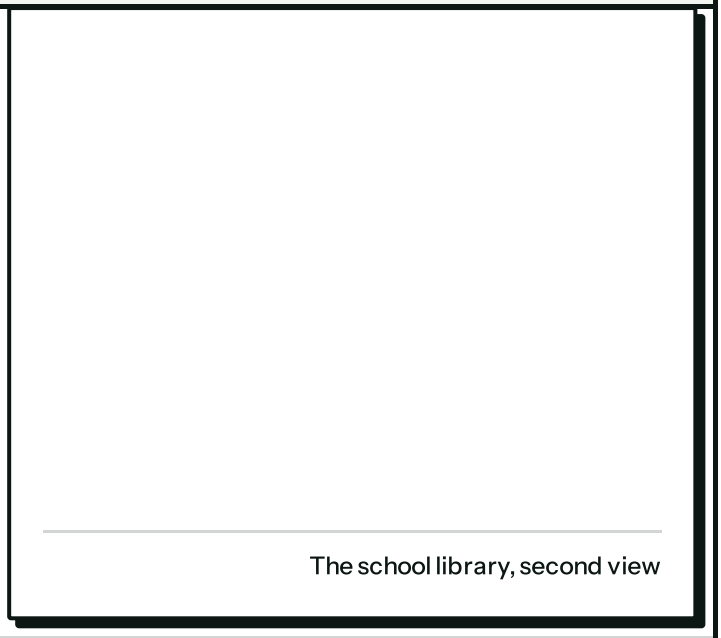
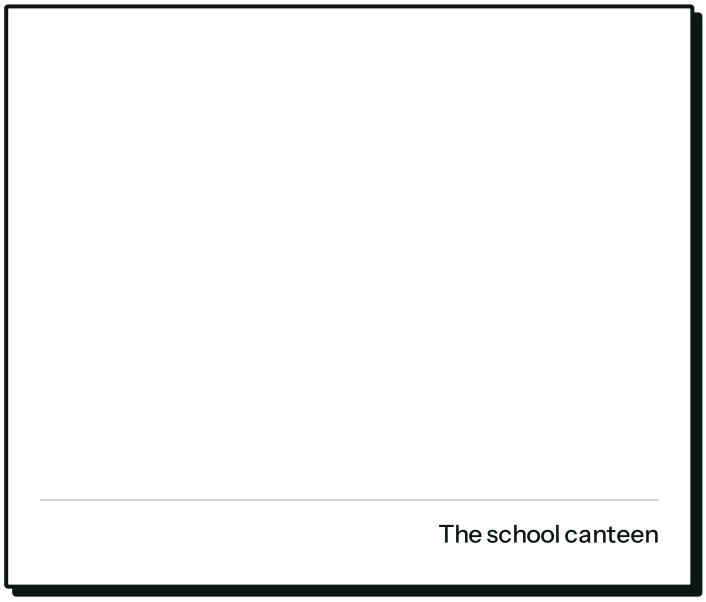
Legazpi City Science High School September 21 9:00 AM to 12:15 NN

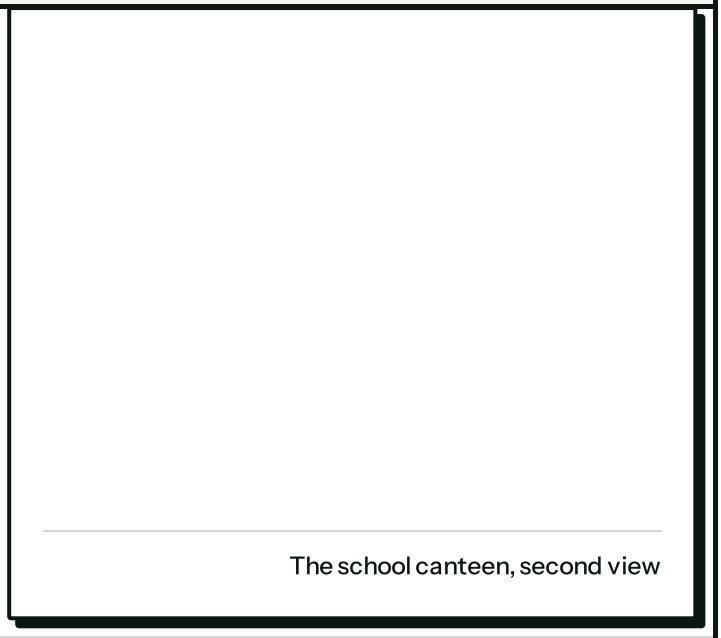
Grade 8 — Linnaeus, Brown, Hooke

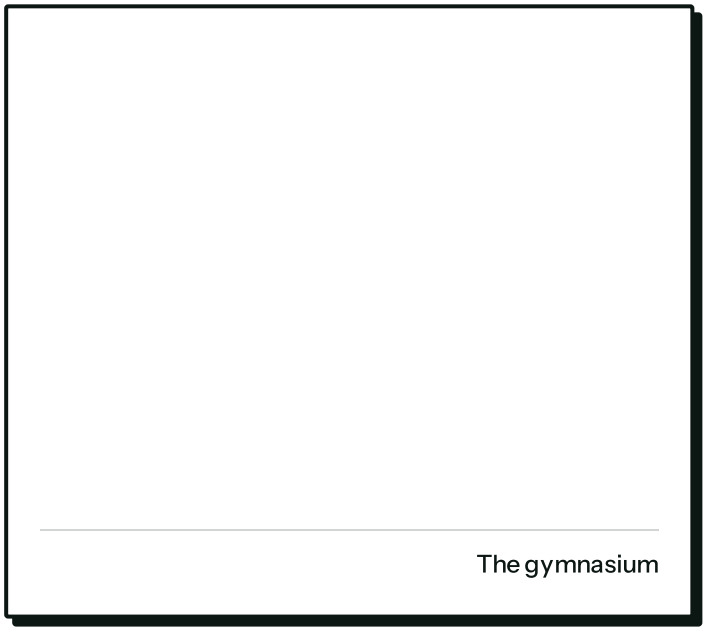
One that responds to physical, social, and cognitive needs together, so students can focus on the learning process itself rather than being pulled toward external factors.

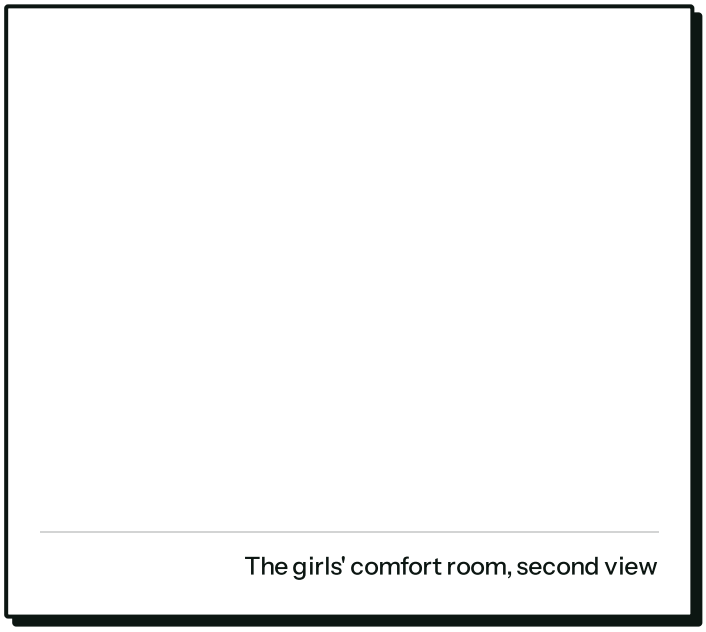
School Facilities Checklist

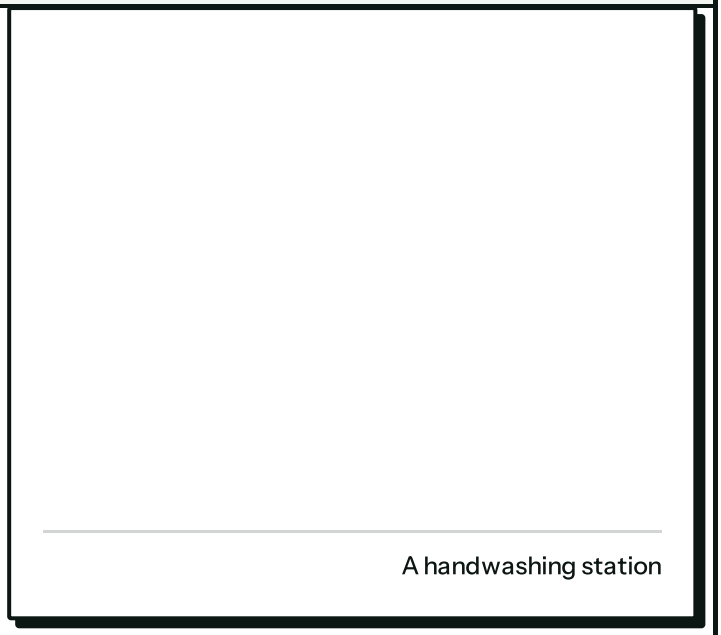
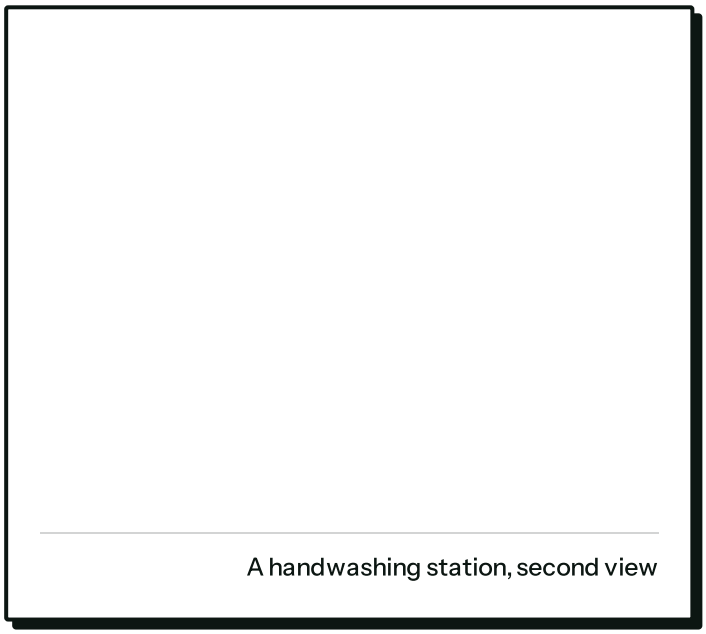
Facility	Status	Description
Office of the Principal	`Available`	Formal, accessible, and organized  The principal's office
Library	`Available`	Quiet, orderly, and conducive to learning  The school library

Facility	Status	Description
		 The school library, second view
Counseling Room	`Not available`	
Canteen / Cafeteria	`Available`	Functional, compact, and secured with counter grilles  The school canteen

Facility	Status	Description
		 The school canteen, second view
Medical Clinic	`Available`	Basic first-aid setup present, but the room was occupied and appeared disorganized at the time of observation  The medical clinic
Audio Visual Room	`Not available`	
Reading Center	`Available`	Cozy, quiet, and accessible to students
Speech Laboratory	`Not available`	Not available — language classes held in regular rooms
Science Laboratory	`Available`	Spacious, well-ventilated, equipped with large activity tables and TV display

Facility	Status	Description
		 The science laboratory
Gymnasium	`Available`	Spacious, open-air, and multipurpose  The gymnasium
Auditorium	`Not available`	Not available — school uses the multi-purpose gym/stage
Home Economics Room	`Not available`	Not available
Industrial Workshop	`Not available`	Not available / integrated into general TLE areas
PTA Office	`Not available`	Not available
Comfort Room (Boys)	`Available`	Functional and tiled, though water supply was noticeably scarce during observation

Facility	Status	Description
Comfort Room (Girls)	`Available`	Functional and tiled with basic sanitary amenities, though water supply was scarce during observation  The girls' comfort room  The girls' comfort room, second view
Computer Room / ICT Room	`Available`	Spacious, well-equipped, and ventilated with learning tech and VR units
Prayer Room / Wellness Room	`Not available`	Not available
Handwashing Station	`Available`	Present, tiled, and posted with proper hygiene guides, but water supply was scarce at the time of observation

Facility	Status	Description
		 A handwashing station  A handwashing station, second view
Robotics / VR Innovation Area (in ICT/Lab)	`Available`	Equipped with VR Box headgear and interactive learning peripherals
Faculty Room	`Available`	While conducive, space is limited. Well-ventilated.

Facility	Status	Description
		 The faculty room

Classroom environment observation questions

Look at the walls of the classroom. What are posted? What heroes, religious figures, lessons, visual aids, and announcements do you see posted?

Linnaeus keeps its walls largely clean and bare, with religious images found centered in the room. Its bulletin board, found at the back, displays student profiles, class officers, infographics on the school's Portable Electronic Device Policy, DepEd's Anti-Bullying Guidelines, and a QR code for reporting bullying and misconduct, along with the school hymn, the Bicol Regional Hymn, and "Pilipinas Kong Mahal." Information is kept minimal so it isn't overwhelming to the viewer. Brown displays a religious image of Mother Mary and the Baby Jesus, though its own information board is empty.

Examine how the furniture is arranged. Where is the teacher's table located? How are the tables and chairs/desks arranged?

The teacher's table is located at the center of the classroom, directly facing the students and positioned in front of the whiteboard/TV so it doesn't obstruct student sightlines. It's devoid of decor and includes a container for students' electronic devices, surrendered during class hours. Desks are arranged in vertical rows following a 2×5 | 3×5 | 2×5 pattern.

What learning materials/equipment are present?

Learning materials usually consist of teacher-prepared PowerPoint presentations cast on the television, viewable clearly from any seat. Learners' resource books are procured for each student and kept under their desks. Equipment present includes a whiteboard, water dispenser, air conditioners, ceiling fans, and an attendance counter.

Observe the students. How many are occupying one room?

Typically 30–35 students per room.

Is the room well-lighted and well-ventilated?

Yes — well-lit (4 bulbs in Linnaeus) and well-ventilated via a combination of air conditioning and ceiling fans.

Classroom Facilities Matrix

Bulletin Board

Found at the back of the room. Information is kept minimal, so it isn't overwhelming to the viewer. In good condition. Contents include student profiles, class officers, infographics on the school's Portable Electronic Device Policy, DepEd's Anti-Bullying Guidelines, a QR code for reporting bullying/misconduct, the school hymn, the Bicol Regional Hymn, and "Pilipinas Kong Mahal."

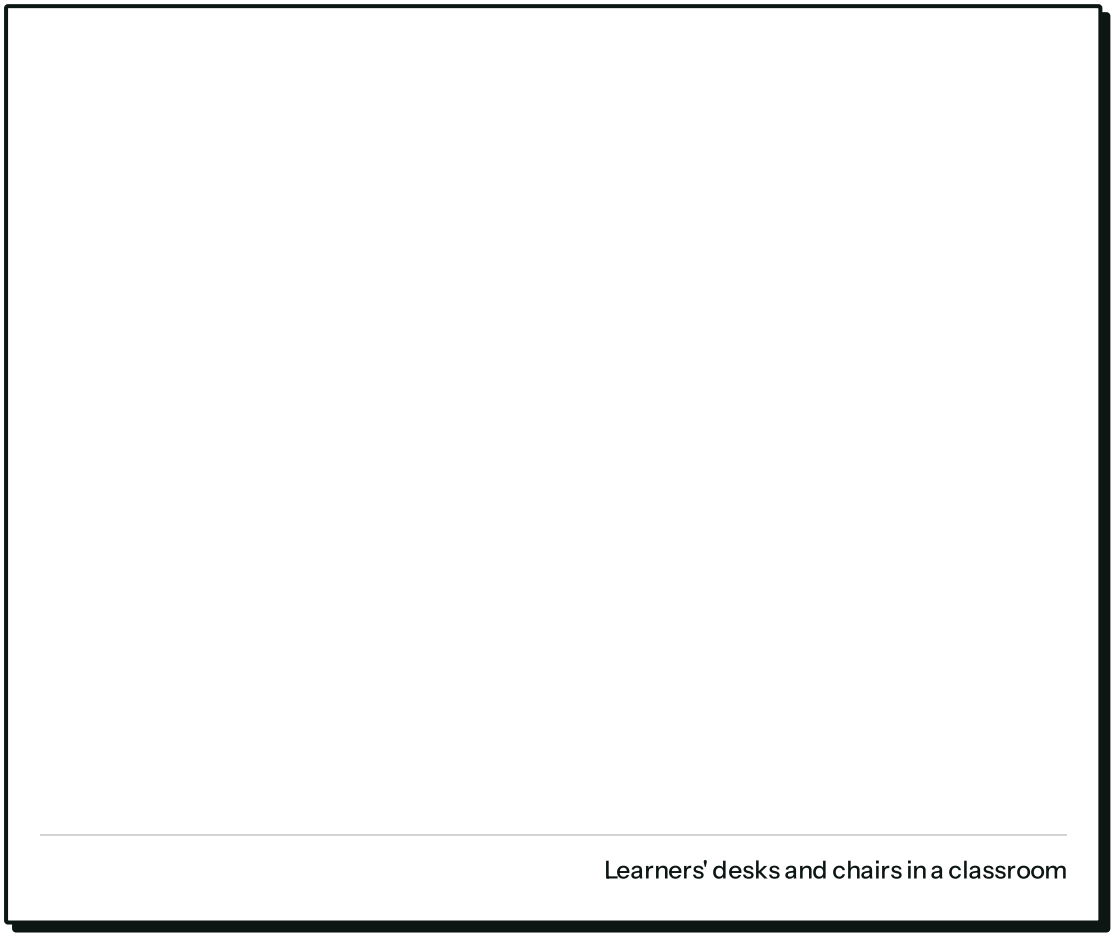
A classroom bulletin board

Teacher's Table

Located at the center of the classroom, directly facing the students, in front of the whiteboard. Devoid of decor; includes a container for students' electronic devices, surrendered during class hours.

Learners' Desk/Chairs

Excellent condition — durable and spacious enough for students. Procured 1:1, so students don't share desk space. Evidence of vandalism is virtually non-existent; desks are regularly cleaned by students. Names printed on paper are placed on the top right corner of each desk. Arranged in vertical rows (2×5, 3×5, 2×5).

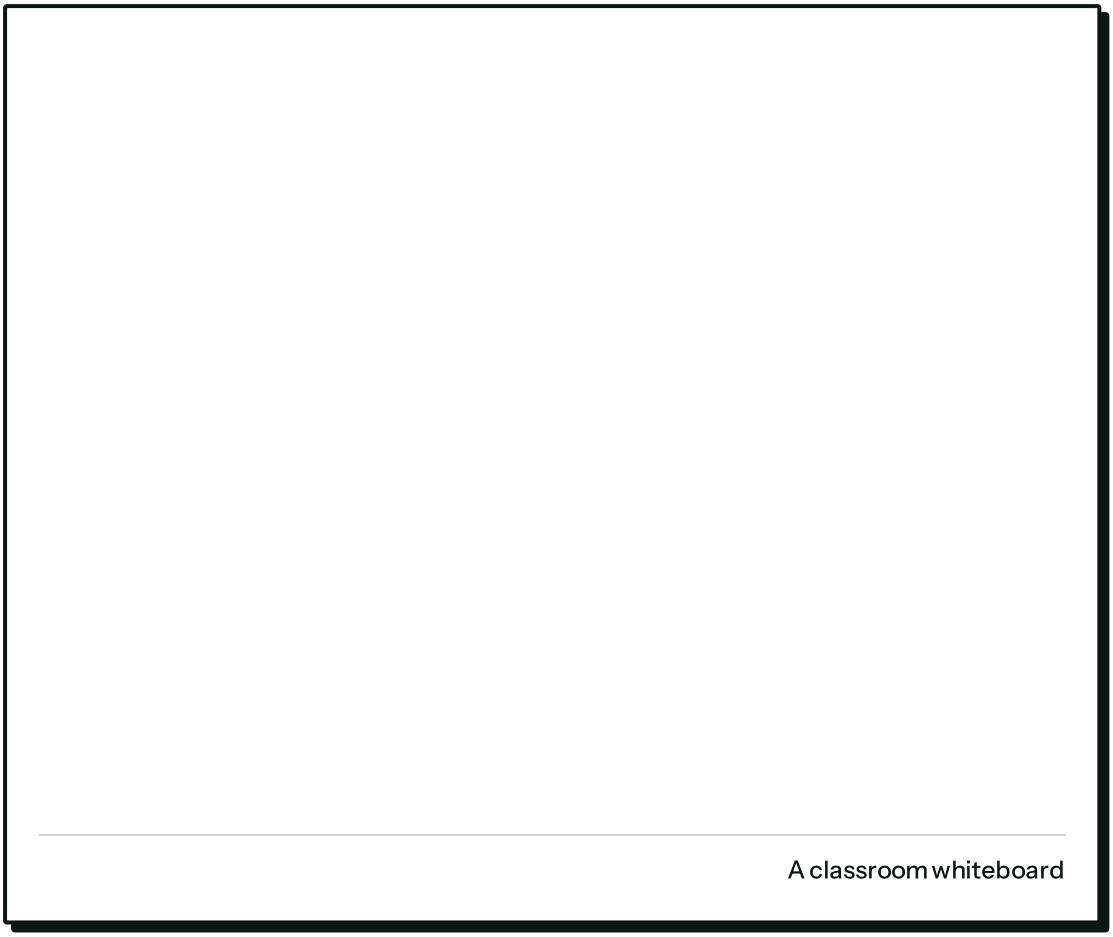


Learners' desks and chairs in a classroom

Learners' desks and chairs in a classroom, second view

Whiteboard

Excellent size, providing great visibility for students no matter where they're seated.



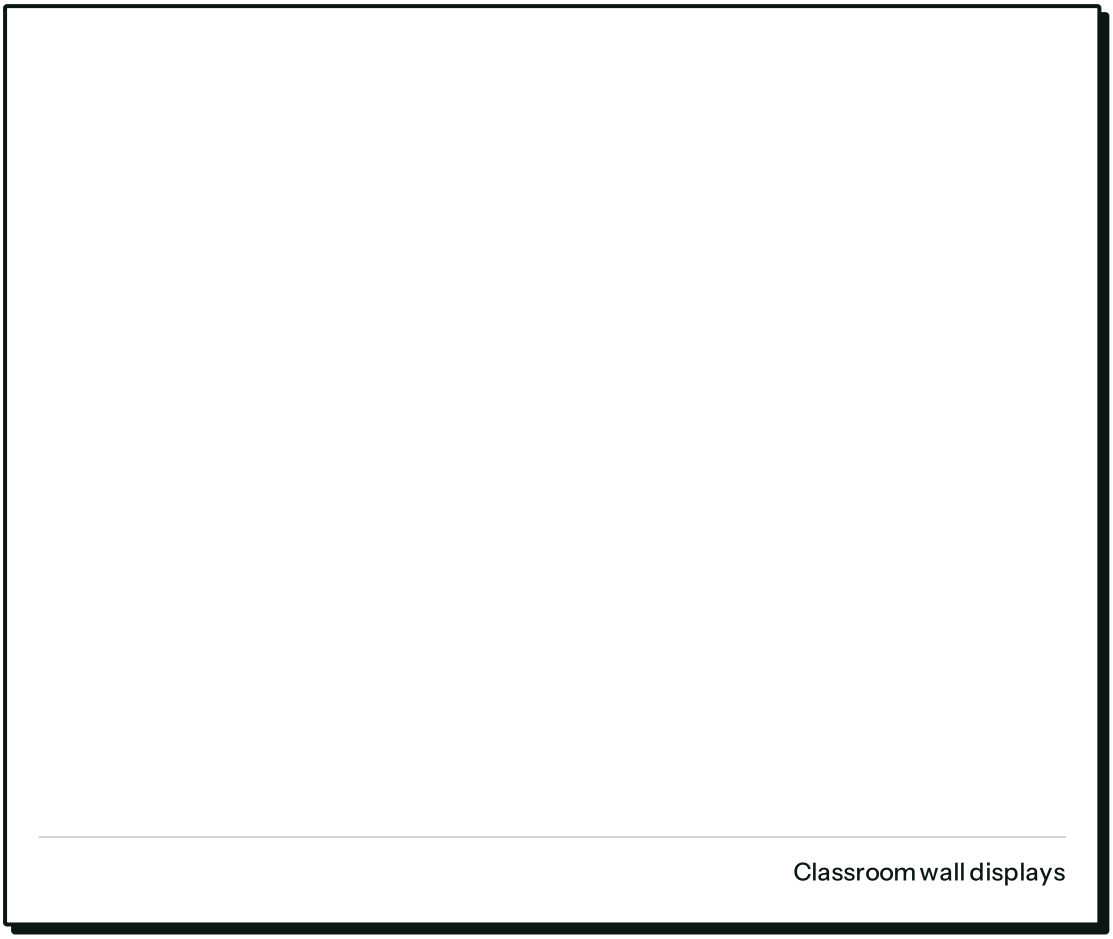
A classroom whiteboard

Learners' Resources/Books

Procured for each student and in relatively good condition. Usually found under their desks.

Wall Displays

In some rooms, images of religious figures can be found, located at the center of the room.



Classroom wall displays

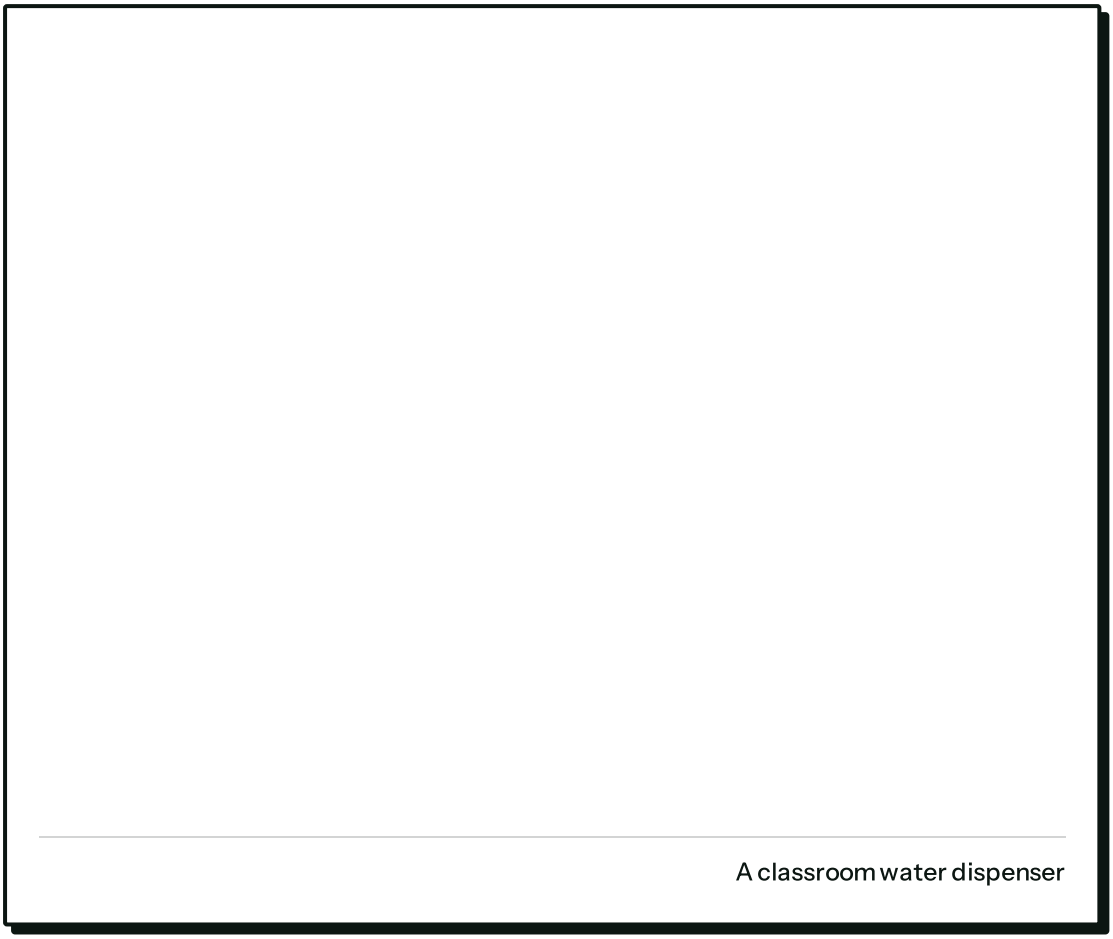
Learning Materials

Usually teacher-prepared PowerPoint presentations cast on the television, viewable excellently from any student's seat.

Learning materials shown on a classroom television

Water Dispenser

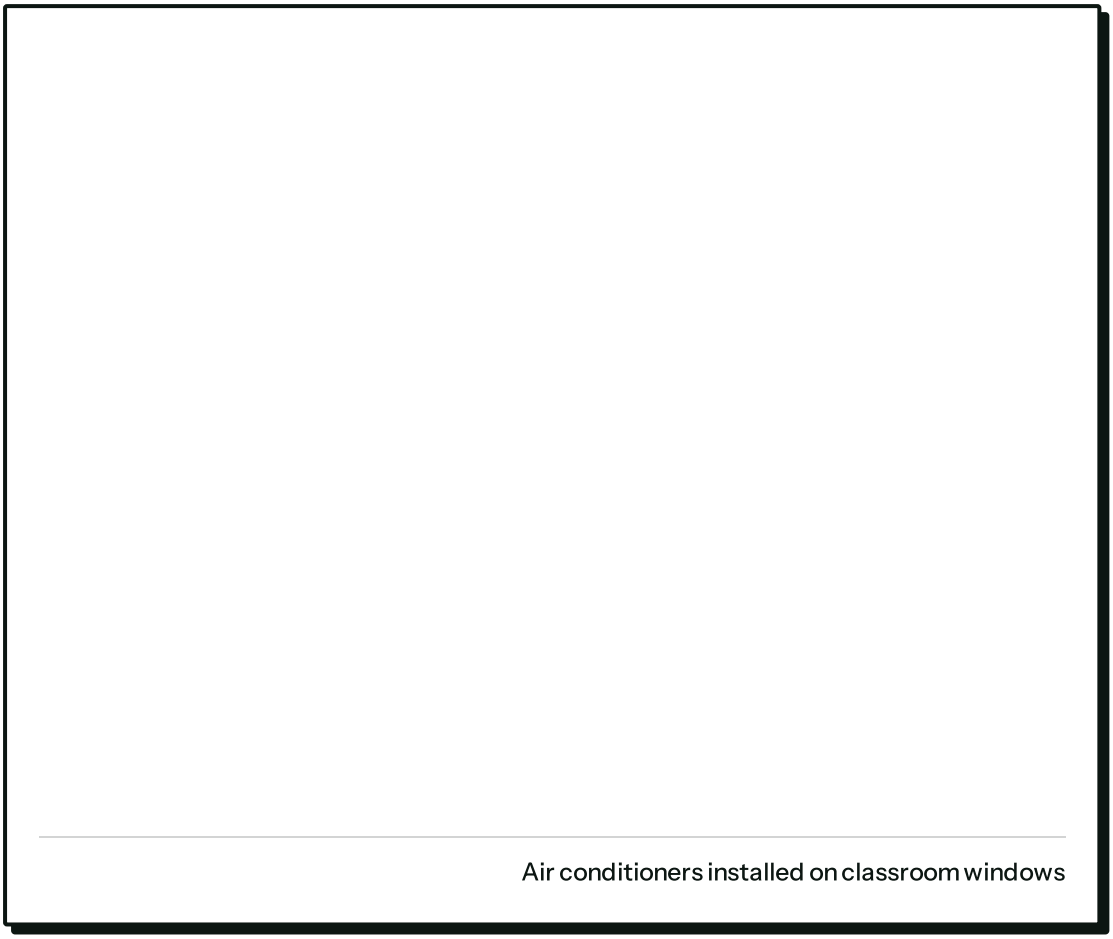
Found at the back of the classroom, usually beside the bulletin board. Maintained regularly, with water refills kept beside it.



A classroom water dispenser

Air Conditioners

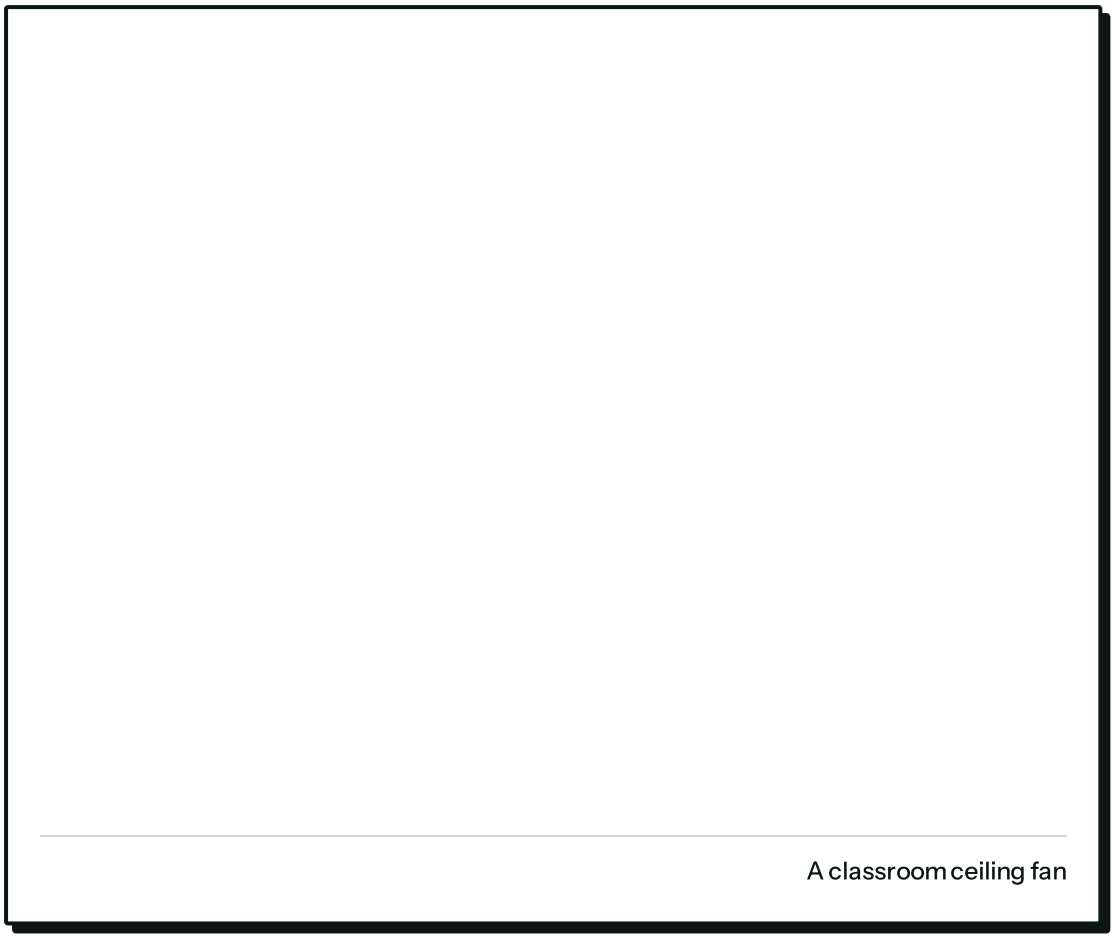
Installed in pairs and in great condition, situated on the windows, providing excellent ventilation for everyone in the room.



Air conditioners installed on classroom windows

Ceiling Fans

Usually four per room, located overhead of the students.



A classroom ceiling fan

Attendance Counter

Updated daily, near the entrance.

School facilities reflection

“ There's clear rapport between teacher and students; the teacher isn't perceived as intimidating. ”

Based on your observations, how do the observed classroom and school environments contribute to the students' learning and well-being?

In total, the teachers foster a casual classroom climate that's largely devoid of tension — though this may partly reflect that observation coincided with orientation days. There's clear rapport between teacher and students; the teacher isn't perceived as intimidating. This plays out in the actual classroom discourse too: teachers banter with students by name, crack jokes tied to local pop culture, and translanguage freely across Bikol-Legazpi, Filipino, and English to keep meaning accessible rather than sticking rigidly to English instruction — the atmosphere stays lighthearted even mid-lesson, with visible laughter and joking exchanges rather than a strictly formal register. Facilities condition-wise beat most public high schools observed elsewhere — aircon and TVs present in every room so far — though the room design itself is typical and rigid, with no decorative elements, and information boards are present but often thin on actual content. Orientation itself seems genuinely valuable here: it clarifies how grades are computed and levels expectations between students and teachers early.

What kind of a) School Campus and b) Classroom is conducive to learning?

One that responds to physical, social, and cognitive needs together, so students can focus on the learning process itself rather than being pulled toward external factors.

“ It's something a teacher chooses to actualize, built day by day, inside whatever classroom they're given. ”

As a future teacher, how will you be able to achieve a school campus and classroom that are conducive to learning?

For me, achieving a conducive learning environment isn't necessarily about the budget a school hands you. The financial aspect matters, but it's not about waiting for the perfect building or the perfect budget — it's about what I personally choose to do with the room I'm currently dealing with. This isn't about being defeatist or submissive; it's about being proactive.

As I've said in my previous answers, a learning environment isn't just the physical — desks and chairs matter, but they're only a fraction of the whole. A learning environment is physical, social, and cognitive together, and I want to make sure the room I'm responsible for responds to all three. Once those parameters are in place, I fill in my part by starting with what I can personally control regardless of infrastructure: the social and the cognitive.

I'm lucky enough to be observing in classrooms at Legazpi City Science High School, where each room has air conditioning and good ventilation. But when I actually enter the DepEd workforce, that may not be the case. I can't always get air conditioning or a well-stocked bulletin board — but I can decide whether my students feel safe enough to belong. Just as I observed my cooperating teacher interact with students — never as a figure of fear, never a monolith who only tells students whether they're right or wrong — I want to build that same kind of rapport. Because when students feel safe enough to realize that the four corners of a room aren't something that cages or demands compliance, but a space to try and to learn, the room stops being

somewhere they're just invited to sit through, and starts being a room made for them.

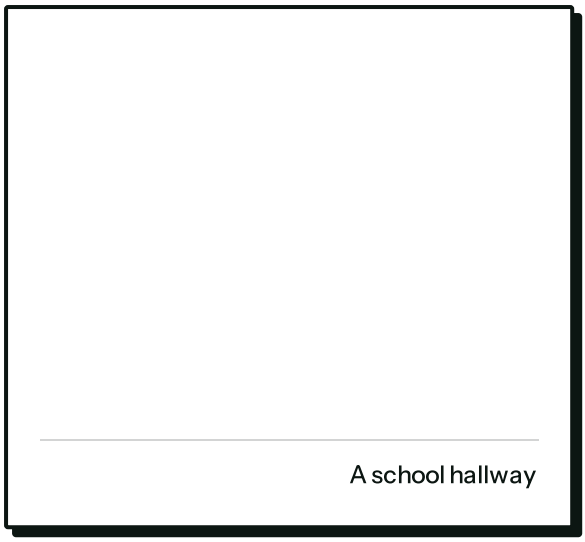
Concretely, that means treating the physical space as worth personalizing even with limited resources — walls that celebrate the students in them, not an empty board — and treating orientation and expectation-setting with real intention rather than going through the motions, the way I saw it done well. "Conducive" isn't a condition handed to you. It's something a teacher chooses to actualize, built day by day, inside whatever classroom they're given.

Personal illustration of an ideal school environment

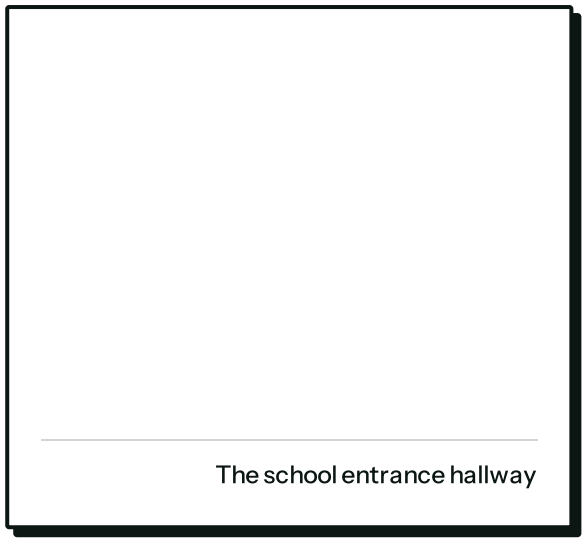
`Sketch/drawing.`



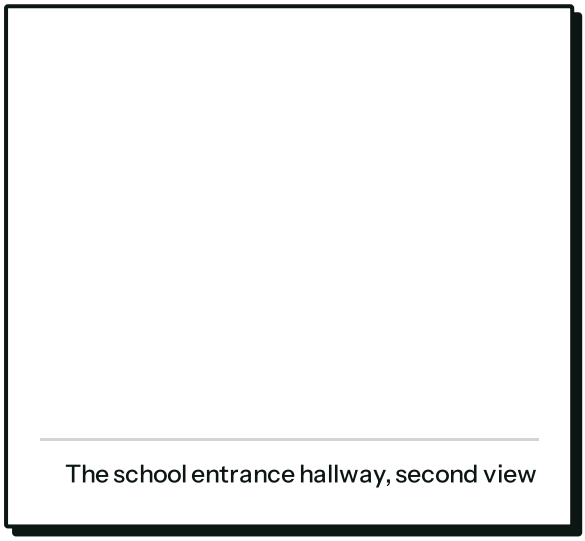
Hand-drawn classroom sketch, inked over an AI-generated line-art base used purely as a loose composition skeleton (no isolated/excluded figures, clustered desks instead of rigid rows, teacher at student eye-level, a dedicated reading/study nook, and a content-rich bulletin board) — directly answering Reflect Q2's point about an environment that responds to physical, social, and cognitive needs together, and correcting the "typical and rigid, no decorative elements" gap noted in the facilities observation.



A school hallway



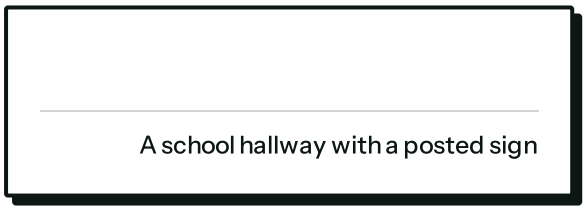
The school entrance hallway



The school entrance hallway, second view



A ramp for persons with disabilities



A school hallway with a posted sign

Psychosocial Environment Checklist

Psychosocial indicator	Red-pen observation stamp
The school compound is clean, safe and secured.	OBSERVED
There is a school canteen where healthy/nutritious food is provided.	OBSERVED
Hand wash facilities and clean water source are available.	Not observed
The students are protected from any forms of verbal and physical violence.	OBSERVED

Psychosocial indicator	Red-pen observation stamp
Seminars on Students' rights are being conducted.	OBSERVED
There is a playground for students with sport facilities.	OBSERVED
Teachers and parents have undergone trainings on Child Protection and basic steps on how to refer students in case of emergency.	OBSERVED

Psychosocial environment reflection

“ the invisible hand guiding students toward real, lived success ”

Is the psychosocial school environment important? Explain.

The psychosocial school environment is an often-overlooked aspect of education — unfortunate, because I'd argue it's the invisible hand guiding students toward real, lived success. It bridges the gap between the cognitive, the emotional, and the human. A positive psychosocial environment lets students learn in a space where stressors and external factors pose no distraction. Students are human beings first, carrying different backgrounds, problems, and variables — and one of the variables with the most direct impact on how much they learn, and how efficiently, is the psychosocial environment they're in.

Every child deserves a school that protects their mind and nurtures their heart. A psychosocial school environment is, in that sense, a fundamental right in modern education — because we cannot expect students to thrive academically while social and emotional factors actively hinder them. When students are wallowed in anxiety, stress, or isolation, they cannot participate wholeheartedly in learning. Creating a psychosocial environment means creating an overall positive school climate — a safety net that lets students unleash their potential without fear or judgment, potential that would otherwise stay stifled by those invisible barriers. To advocate for a healthy psychosocial environment is to fight for a place where peer relationships are built on mutual respect and mental health is prioritized over rigid conformity — and in doing so, to build a humane, compassionate education system.

“ I would actively seek out the quietest voices in the room and make sure they feel protected, acknowledged, and included. ”

Imagine that you are now a professional teacher — how do you create a psychosocial environment in your school? Explain.

The psychosocial school environment is one I will particularly focus on. Stepping into that classroom, I would champion it not just as a space for learning but as a student-centered sanctuary rooted in emotional safety, inclusion, and empowerment.

First, I would dismantle the invisible hierarchy between teacher and student — the assumption that I am superior and they are not — and replace it with a horizontal relationship, one where we see each other as partners. Mistakes wouldn't be penalized or held against students, but celebrated as proof of growth and met with encouragement to keep trying. I would actively seek out the quietest voices in the room and make sure they feel protected, acknowledged, and included. If I can model these qualities, I hope my students become empowered to be more collaborative and open — to find ways to lift each other up and build a tight-knit community of allies rather than competitors.

“ Change a student's environment, and you transform their entire capacity to learn. ”

What is the impact of the psychosocial school environment on student learning outcomes? Explain.

The impact is life-changing. Change a student's environment, and you transform their entire capacity to learn.

Students face invisible adversaries teachers aren't always aware of — anxiety, a bad mood, academic stress — the things that genuinely hold them back from learning, participating, and belonging in the classroom. When teachers take it upon themselves to lessen that burden, to control what can be controlled, we lift that fog and unleash students' natural curiosity, focus, and drive to succeed.

In doing so, we cultivate an attitude toward the love of learning and growth. Students stop showing up out of fear of penalty or failure, and start showing up out of intrinsic motivation — a genuine love of discovery. That value-based, attitude-driven shift is a sustainable, lifelong change, one that leads to better outcomes far beyond the classroom.

03 · Learner Behavior and Motivation

Legazpi City Science High School Linnaeus (Sept 21), Hooke (Oct 8)

Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI

Activity 1
Observing Learner Behavior and Motivation

Learners observed

Grade 8 — Hooke

A1 **Active learner**

Reads/watches documentaries (Atom Araullo, Kara David); structured home study routine

A2 **Active learner**

Age: **13** Gender: **F**

Draws, writes, cosplays; celebrates achievements with parents

H1 **Hesitant learner**

Age: **13** Gender: **Male**

Writes privately in a journal rather than seeking others out; answered "Nothing" to how they celebrate achievement

H2 **Hesitant learner**

Brief, low-elaboration answers throughout

Interview Guide to the Learners

What are your interests?

Interests split along a creative/academic-leisure line rather than by active/hesitant status. A1 and H1 both lean toward creative-documentary pursuits — A1 watches documentaries (Atom Araullo, Kara David), H1 draws maps and writes literary texts. A2 and H2 lean toward sensory/recreational interests — A2 through drawing, music, sports, and cosplay; H2 through music, food, and sleep. Notably, interest type doesn't track with classroom participation level — both an active and a hesitant learner fall on each side.

Do you have study time at home?

All four report having study time, but with different structure. A1 and H2 keep a fixed or near-daily routine (A1: after school and weekends until midnight; H1: "often"). A2 is the outlier — study time is conditional on an upcoming test rather than routine. H2 confirms simply, without elaboration.

Do you have a nook with books or other learning materials at home? Which place at home do you study?

All four have a dedicated or semi-dedicated study space, though quality varies. A1 and H1 both describe deliberately organized spaces — a full study room (A1) and a desk placed adjacent to the living room (H1). A2 has books but no nook, studying in her room by default. H2 has materials (science books) and a named "study area," landing in between.

“ Solitary coping as a first instinct is a shared trait across both hesitant learners. ”

What do you do when you feel down or have a problem? What do you do to meet your emotional needs?

This is where the active/hesitant split shows up most clearly. The two active learners (A1, A2) both cope through outward distraction — A1 watches funny or animal videos, A2 takes a break with her own interests before problem-solving. The two hesitant learners (H1, H2) both default to internal or solitary processing — H1 writes privately in a journal or thinks through "logics & philosophy"; H2 either talks to someone trusted or simply keeps problems to himself. Solitary coping as a first instinct is a shared trait across both hesitant learners.

What do you do when you achieve something at school or do something good?

Active learners externalize achievement — A1 posts online or celebrates with family over a meal; A2 tells her parents directly and celebrates with them. Hesitant learners do not: H2 rewards himself privately with no social component, and H1's answer is simply "Nothing" — no celebration ritual at all, the starkest single data point across all four interviews.

How do your parents discipline you? Do you have house rules?

Discipline style tracks closely with active/hesitant status here too. Both active learners describe explanation-based discipline without rigid rule structures — A1's parents "state what I did wrongly and correct it by setting examples," A2's parents scold but forgive, with no formal house rules. Both hesitant learners describe more directive households — H2 has a single compliance rule ("Listen & Follow"), and H1's household uses verbal discipline that is "seldom physical, but used nonetheless," alongside confirmed house rules.

How do they monitor your performance in school? How do they motivate you?

Active learners describe low-pressure, trust-based monitoring — A1's parents don't pressure her, trusting her own intellect; A2's parents don't monitor closely since she self-reports, and they comfort rather than punish low scores. Hesitant learners describe monitoring as external and less collaborative — H2's parents ask about performance but motivate transactionally ("promise to give me my wants"); H1's parents "assume" from his grades and activities and direct him accordingly, and when asked how they motivate him, H1 responds "I am not aware" — the clearest instance across all four interviews of a learner lacking visibility into his own support structure.

What makes you love going to school? Do you have difficulty in any subjects? What is it?

All four identify a positive draw to school, but the source differs. A1 and A2 both cite the social dimension — friends — as mattering as much as or more than academics; A2 names math as her specific difficulty. H2 cites "discovering new things" and also names math as a difficulty. H1 cites a related but distinct reason — access to things unavailable at home, plus the harder-to-articulate pull of "inspiration" — and names Filipino and Values Education, not math, as his difficulty.

Answer the following question:

“ Homes whose environment is founded on mutual trust, respect for autonomy, and clear communication possibly mediate students toward better participation and perspective inside the classroom. ”

Based on the interview, what home environment factors do you think contribute to the motivation and behavior of the learner that affect his/her learning? Briefly discuss the factors you have cited.

A common thread becomes apparent across the students I have identified as "active" and "inactive" in the classroom — and it hinges primarily on how communication and autonomy are handled at home. A1 and A2, the more active students observed, come from homes where achievement is shared and celebrated. A1 shares that she feels proud of her successes and posts them on social media, whereas A2 tells her parents directly and celebrates together. In terms of discipline, correction comes as an avenue for explaining rationally why certain behaviors are unideal — as opposed to a punitive measure, or something imposed. A1 shares that her parents simply sit down and tell her exactly what she did wrong, correcting it by setting examples. A2's parents scold but immediately forgive, and no explicit, rigid house rules are established in the household. But perhaps the most telling difference between the pair is where academic motivation to succeed actualizes — in their case, it comes from a place of trust among themselves and with their parents, rather than pressure. As A1 puts it, her parents "trust my intellect and motivate me by not pressuring me"; A2, on the other hand, reveals that when she underperforms in class, her parents console her and resist an almost-invasive monitoring attitude toward her academics. In this sense, both students' home environments recognize, respect,

and encourage their autonomy — they are given the opportunity to direct their own learning without any overt or covert threat.

Noticeably, H1 and H2, identified as the less active in school, deviate from the conditions and characteristics discussed above. An overarching mechanism observed among the two is a tendency to default to solitary behavior regulation. H1 writes in his journal to process, or to "think about philosophy and logic"; H2, meanwhile, confides in a trusted peer or simply "keeps it to myself." Successes, not limited to academic ones, are not necessarily a point of celebration to be shared with others — contrasting with A1 and A2. H1 simply states "nothing," and H2 celebrates regardless, but privately, rather than sharing the moment. Discipline is much more pronounced in both households. For instance, per H1, a strict, singular rule ("listen and follow") exists in their house. For H2, rules are transactional ("they promise to give me what I want") rather than relational. H1's situation shows this most clearly; he says his parents "assume from my grades and works and command me to do something they thought of," and when asked how they motivate him, his answer is "I am not aware." This illustrates a household in which communication and rule-enforcing exist on a one-way street, where ultimately the student is left to wonder why decisions are made.

The interviews reveal a somewhat surprising conclusion: the factors that influence student motivation and behavior affecting their learning rest not on resources or having a dedicated study space — all four interviewees were adequately provided for in this regard — but rather on the style of involvement itself. Homes whose environment is founded on mutual trust, respect for autonomy, and clear communication possibly mediate students toward better participation and perspective inside the classroom. On the contrary, homes built around command, assumption, or transaction appear to produce heavily solitary behaviors among students when it comes to self-regulation — participation also becomes more guarded. This underscores the value of the cold-

calling pattern I observed, as it helps nudge these "inactive" students to participate, incentivizing them to do so when a structure is introduced, rather than relying on their own volition.

Activity 2 (Individual Activity)

Teacher-guided activities/practices that address learners' gender, needs, strengths, interests, and experiences

Class Observation

An Observation Guide for the Learners' Behavior and Motivation

How would you describe the interaction in the classroom? Do the students interact with one another and with the teacher?

Playful and bantering, but respectful. The teacher jokes with students by name, references shared pop-culture touchpoints (e.g., Coco Martin, K-pop), and the room stays lighthearted even mid-lesson rather than tense or strictly formal.

Observe the learners seated in front and at the back of the classroom. How do they behave and interact? Were those seated in front more active than those seated at the back?

There is no observable difference in participation or attention between students seated in front and those seated at the back. Both groups interact well with one another and behave appropriately, and even students at the back stay attentive to what the teacher is saying — the room's acoustics hold up well, and the teacher actively engages students across the room rather than letting focus concentrate on a single row or section.

During the teaching-learning process, how would you describe the relationship among the learners? Do they cooperate with one another, or do they compete instead?

Collaborative rather than competitive — observed clearly in the synonym-upgrade activity, where students built on each other's word suggestions as a shared, cumulative exercise rather than racing to "win" with the best answer.

Who among the pupils actively participates? Do some of them ask for most help?

Participation is broad rather than concentrated among a few vocal students, largely because the teacher uses index-card cold-calling to draw names at random rather than relying on volunteers — a deliberate structure for distributing turns fairly.

What transpires when the teacher asks questions to the class? Do the pupils participate actively? What happens when a pupil cannot answer the question? Do others raise their hands to answer, or do they help their classmates?

Students respond eagerly when called on. Correct answers get immediate verbal affirmation; when an answer is partial or needs more depth, the teacher follows up with a HOTS "why" question rather than simply moving on or supplying the answer herself.

What encourages them to participate or perform? What diminishes their enthusiasm for participating/performing?

Humor, code-switching (Bikol-Legazpi/Filipino/English), and relatable references clearly encourage participation. Nothing diminishing enthusiasm has been directly observed yet.

Describe learner behavior and motivation based on what you have observed.

Overall, students read as engaged and comfortable, in a classroom culture built around humor and low-stakes participation rather than fear of being wrong.

Interview with a Teacher

Resource Teacher: Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI

School: Legazpi City Science High School

Grade Level / Subject: English 8

Date of Interview: October 12, 2026

Part 1 — Principles & Practices on Learner Behavior and Motivation

“ I am not just teaching English; I am also helping shape their character. ”

Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

What principles or practices do you follow when addressing your students' behavior in class?

> As a teacher, I try to be firm but understanding. When a student misbehaves, I do not immediately judge them because I believe there may be a reason behind their actions. I talk to them, remind them of our classroom rules, and help them understand the consequences of their choices. I always tell myself that I am not just teaching English; I am also helping shape their character.

— **Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI** · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

“ What matters is that they try and keep improving. ”

Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

How do you motivate your students to participate and perform well?

> I encourage my students by recognizing their efforts, even the small ones. I know that not everyone is confident enough to speak up or answer questions, so I try to make my classroom a place where they feel comfortable making mistakes and learning from them. I always remind them that they do not have to get everything right the first time. What matters is that they try and keep improving.

— **Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI** · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

“ there is more to each student than what I see during class discussions. ”

Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

Have you noticed differences in how students interact with you or with each other outside the classroom, compared to inside it? Could you describe this?

> Yes, I notice that some students who are quiet inside the classroom become more talkative and comfortable when we meet outside. They are more open to sharing stories and joking around. I enjoy those moments because I get to see another side of them. It also helps me understand my students better and reminds me that there is more to each student than what I see during class discussions.

— **Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI** · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

Part 2 — Impact of Individual Differences

“ I do my best to make sure that no student feels left behind. ”

Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

How do you address the diverse needs, backgrounds, or personalities of your students in your teaching?

> I always remind myself that my students are different from one another. Some learn quickly, while others need more time and guidance. So, I try to vary my activities, give additional help when needed, and provide opportunities for different students to shine. I may not always be able to meet every need perfectly, but I do my best to make sure that no student feels left behind.

— **Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI** · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

“ I need to understand them before I can effectively help them. ”

Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

In your experience, how do individual differences among learners (e.g., personality, home environment, learning pace) affect their behavior and motivation in class?

> I have observed that a student's behavior in class is sometimes influenced by what they experience outside school. Some are confident and active, while others are quiet or easily discouraged. Some also need more time to learn than their classmates. This reminds me not to compare students because I may not know what they are going through. As a teacher, I need to understand them before I can effectively help them.

— **Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI** · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

“ a little patience and encouragement can help a student slowly gain confidence. ”

Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

Do you adjust your approach for students who seem less motivated or more hesitant to participate? If so, how?

> Yes. I try to encourage them without putting too much pressure on them. Sometimes, I start by asking simpler questions or giving them opportunities to work with classmates they are comfortable with. I also talk to them when necessary to understand what makes participation difficult for them. I believe that a little patience and encouragement can help a student slowly gain confidence.

— **Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI** · English 8 · Legazpi City Science High School · October 12, 2026

Teacher-guided practices

How do you demonstrate the following teacher-guided practice in your class? Complete the table below.

Teacher-guided activities/practices that address learners' gender, needs, strengths, interests, and experiences.	**My illustrations of practice:**
1. Using gender-fair language in the classroom.	The teacher's own example sentences alternate consistently between "the boy" and "the girl" rather than defaulting to one gender, and a student's revised paragraph explicitly names "the boys and the girls" together rather than a generic "students."
2. Providing equal opportunities for learners	Index-card cold-calling distributes turns fairly across the whole class rather than relying on

Teacher-guided activities/practices that address learners' gender, needs, strengths, interests, and experiences.	My illustrations of practice:
regardless of gender.	volunteers, who tend to skew toward more outspoken students.
3. Taking measures to prevent bullying.	Not directly observed in this classroom session — the school's bulletin board (Ep. 2 note) displays DepEd's Anti-Bullying Guidelines and a QR code for reporting, but that's a schoolwide measure, not something specific to this teacher's classroom practice.
5. Encouraging the learners' appropriate interests.	Teacher draws on references students actually relate to — Coco Martin, K-pop/"Gangnam" style, local slang — to keep the lesson engaging on their own terms.
6. Providing opportunities and activities that enhance learners' strengths.	The paragraph-revision activity has multiple students read their own individually reworked versions aloud, letting each showcase their own writing choices rather than converging on one "correct" answer.
7. Relating lessons and activities to the learners' personal experiences.	Teacher uses everyday, lived scenarios (going to a birthday party, waiting for someone outside, elementary memories of writing "how to cook rice") to teach diction/style.

Answer the following questions:

“ index-card cold-calling ensures every student has the chance to participate ”

From the class observation you have done, how did the teacher address diversity in learner behavior and motivation?

The teacher addresses diversity through structural accommodations rather than individualized ones. Regardless of a student's gender, knowledge level, or background, index-card cold-calling ensures every student has the chance to participate — so students who might otherwise stay inactive, simply waiting for an opening, are given one. Gender representation is also made explicit and normalized through the teacher's use of gender-fair phrasing in example sentences — modern, inclusive pronoun use woven naturally into instruction rather than treated as exceptional. To tap into students' actual social contexts, the teacher draws on relatable cultural references to keep varied interests engaged, and lets multiple students share their own individually reworked paragraphs rather than converging on a single "correct" version.

“ it removes reliance on remembering to call on quieter students ”

As a soon-to-be teacher in the near future, what kind of teaching and learning process will you have in your classroom considering learners' diversity?

I want to build a diversity-responsive classroom into its structure, not just my intentions. The way my cooperating teacher used cold-calling to randomly call on students is something I want to carry forward — it removes reliance on remembering to call on quieter students, and it builds in the awareness that content should flex toward what my specific students actually relate to, rather than a fixed curriculum voice.

“ It's the accumulation of small structural choices that, taken together, produce a domino effect — keeping the classroom from defaulting to whoever is loudest. ”

Reflect on the impact of individual differences and inclusivity on learners' interaction, behaviour and motivation.

One thing I've realized from observation is that individual differences aren't always overt — more often, it's the covert differences teachers really need to stay aware of. These differences shape not just what students need, but how visibly they need it. Some manifest explicitly, like an eager volunteer; others stay invisible until a teacher builds structures — like cold-calling — that bring them to the surface. In this sense, inclusivity isn't a single decision to accommodate. It's the accumulation of small structural choices that, taken together, produce a domino effect — keeping the classroom from defaulting to whoever is loudest.

Act IV: Evidence and appendices

Herson N. Alamo (Teacher VI · Secondary English & Campus Journalism Mentor)

Subject area: English (Journalism, Composition, and Literature)

Cooperating school: Cooperating Public Secondary School (DepEd Albay / Legazpi Division)

Mr. Herson N. Alamo holds the rank of Teacher VI in the Department of Education, serving as a seasoned secondary English educator and publication adviser. Across all observed sessions in Field Study 1, his classroom practice exemplified the integration of structured DepEd lesson planning, Socratic questioning, and tactile instructional scaffolding.

Primary worksheet PDFs

Episode 02: The Learning Environment	*Worksheet PDF coming soon*
Episode 03: Learner Behavior and Motivation	*Worksheet PDF coming soon*

Clearance and endorsement

Status: Cleared / Signed

Office: Experiential Learning Office, Bicol University College of Education

This certifies that Francois Joshua L. Bajandi, BSEd English IV, has satisfactorily fulfilled the classroom observation requirements and documentary coursework for Field Study 1 under the supervision of Mr. Herson N. Alamo, Teacher VI.